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Reg.No:.....

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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION APRIL 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG2DSCHIS100 - THEMES IN GLOBAL HISTORY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answers Answer any 10 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. What is meant by millenarianism? [U] / [CO1] - Millenarianism is the belief that the current trajectory of historical time is destined for a sudden, apocalyptic rupture. Following this dramatic end, believers anticipate the triumphant return of a utopian golden age.
2. What is meant by Synchronic Approach towards Time? [U] / [CO1] - Synchronic approach to time is defined as a method that involves "freezing time to examine cross-sections of phenomena" rather than following a continuous, year-by-year (annalistic) sequence. It treats history not as a continuous flowing process, but as one characterized by "rupture.
3. What is meant by Autocuing? [U] / [CO1] - The ability to recall specific memories independent of environment - only humans have self-initiated access to memory or autocuing, with this human can create recurrent loops of thinking, precisely locate and avoid unwanted items, and transcend the immediate environment.
4. Make a short note on Patriarchal Family [K] / [CO2] - A patriarchal family is a social structure where the eldest male holds the primary authority over the household. In this system, he controls the family's resources, makes the major decisions, and lineage is typically traced through the male line.
5. What is meant by Extra-Economic Extraction? [U] / [CO4] - Extra-economic extraction is the process where an exploiting ruling class appropriates surplus wealth or labour from direct producers using physical force, legal privilege, or political power rather than economic mechanisms – associated with pre-capitalist wealth accumulation.
6. What is meant by Homo Religiosus? [U] / [CO2] - The Concept of homo religious argues that human beings, even the primitive human, are fully religious at any stage of existence – a kind of 'foreshadowed' existence of god among even early human beings as species being.

7. What is meant by *Peculium*? [K] / [CO2] – *Peculium* was a voluntary grant of property assigned to a slave (or children) for use and management. A slave could use the profit from *peculium* to buy freedom, or transmit it to heirs or continue business as freedmen.
8. What is meant by Nationalism as Invented Tradition? [K] / [CO4] – Argument put forward by Eric Hobsbawm while theorizing nationalism - A nation's sense of ancient historical continuity and cultural purity is actually a modern myth, relying on newly created rituals and symbols to legitimize political institutions and forge a cohesive national identity.
9. Define 'Dictatorship of the Proletariat' [K] / [CO5] - In Marxist theory, the "dictatorship of the proletariat" is a transitional state where the working class holds absolute political power. During this phase, workers use their authority to dismantle the capitalist system and pave the way for a classless, communist society.
10. What is meant by Means of Production? [U] / [CO5] - The physical, non-human resources—such as factories, land, tools, and raw materials—required to produce economic goods and services. Whoever owns these vital resources fundamentally dictates the production process, power dynamics and social relations within a society.
11. How does Chakrabarty relate the Anthropocene to historical thinking? [An] / [CO1] - Dipesh Chakrabarty argues that the Anthropocene collapses the traditional divide between human and natural history because humanity now acts as a planetary, geological force - Consequently, historians must rethink narratives of capitalist modernity and human freedom, recognizing that these histories are inextricably bound to the fossil-fuel consumption driving our global ecological crisis.
12. Who is Alexander Yersin? [K] / [CO1] - A Swiss-French scientist, discovered the plague bacillus in 1894.

Part B Short

Essay Answer any 6 questions Each question carries 5 marks

13. Outline the primates use of stone and its implication in their social life [U] / [CO1] - Throughout evolutionary history, primates such as chimpanzees and apes have voluntarily used stones for basic activities like searching for food and attacking others. This innate primate propensity to manipulate objects and explore the environment is facilitated by their specific anatomy, including larger brains, dexterous hands, and specialized shoulder construction. However, this baseline tool use lacks the intelligent adaptability, foresight, and planning seen in later stages of human evolution. It was only with the later emergence of deliberate hominid stone tool manufacturing that profound social implications developed, enabling complex group interaction, cooperation, and division of labour that far exceeded basic chimpanzee abilities.
14. Discuss the origin of the romanticized idea of the environment [U] / [CO1] - The romanticized idea of the environment emerged in the late eighteenth and nineteenth centuries as a cultural backlash against the ecological degradation and rationalist utilitarianism of the Industrial Revolution. Championed by Romantic writers and artists, this movement transformed the dominant perception of nature from a hostile

wasteland or an extractable resource into a pristine, spiritually elevating sanctuary of sublime beauty. However, this idealized construction of "untouched wilderness" was fundamentally a historical myth, as it systematically erased the long histories of indigenous populations who had actively managed and shaped those landscapes for millennia.

15. Locate the significance of the capacity for inventing and retrieving word and use of grammar invention in human cognitive evolution [U] / [CO1] - The capacity for inventing and retrieving words, culminating in the development of literacy, marked a major cognitive breakthrough by enabling the externalization of human memory. This shift from an impermanent biological memory to enduring, reformattable external records fundamentally altered the brain's functional architecture and vastly expanded human ability to store, retrieve, and organize knowledge. Consequently, the use of external symbols and a vast reading lexicon created an "externally programmable" semantic memory system, allowing humans to transcend time and space while collaborating on mental work. Grammatical inventions provide a framework to the language and structure to the day to day affairs.
16. Examine the technological process of the decline of the Bronze Age Civilizations and the Emergence of Iron Age Empires [U] / [CO4] - The Bronze Age civilizations relied on highly centralized palace economies and fragile, long-distance trade networks to acquire the rare tin and copper necessary for bronze metallurgy. When systemic shocks—such as natural disasters, migrations, and internal rebellions around 1200 BCE—severed these international supply chains, elite-controlled bronze production halted, causing the rapid collapse of these interconnected states. Forced to adapt, surviving societies developed high-temperature smelting techniques to process iron—a widely abundant local ore—which democratized toolmaking and armed the rise of new, expansionist empires with cheaper, mass-produced weaponry.
17. Examine why iron got a preference over bronze among the early human civilization [An] / [CO2] - Early bloomery iron was initially inferior to bronze in both tensile strength and castability, it ultimately gained preference following the accidental discovery of carburization, or steeling. By reheating iron in charcoal fires, blacksmiths diffused carbon into the metal to create carbon steel, which could achieve tensile strengths significantly higher than those of bronze. The subsequent mastery of quenching to further harden the metal and tempering to reduce its brittleness cemented iron's superiority, allowing civilizations to produce exceptionally durable tools and weapons.
18. Examine the economic growth achieved with the Industrial Revolution [U] / [CO5] - The industrial revolution is noted for the unprecedented technological advancement and a rising per capita income: between 1500 and 1820 world population grew annually by 0.29 per cent, gross domestic product (GDP) per capita by 0.04 per cent, and the world’s GDP by 0.33 per cent. Between 1820 and 1992, however, the same categories witnessed a growth rate of 0.95 per cent, 1.21 per cent, and 2.17 per cent respectively. Mechanization, the emergence of fuel technology, and associated developments in the iron, steel, and metal working created engineering as a separate

industry. The cognitive nature of science transformed into mechanization and technological development.

19. Critically examine the role of common culture as a cementing force of nationalism [E] / [CO4] - Culture plays a foundational role in nationalism as nations are defined by cultural peculiarities that make them unique and distinct from others - Cultural homogeneity, constituted through common language, institutions, religion, and historical experience, forms the psychological bond that unites a tightly knit group of people into a nation. Ernest Gellner further emphasizes that nationalism developed as a specially cultivated, standardized, education-based literate culture, a garden culture, opposed to wild cultures, suggesting that nationalism itself is a cultural project. However, Eric Hobsbawm challenges the notion of cultural purity by arguing that beliefs in cultural continuity are myths, with nation-states constructing "invented traditions" that use symbolic practices to establish cohesion and legitimize institutions.
20. What were the major technological advancements of the Industrial Era, and how did they contribute to human dominance over nature? To what extent did these innovations shape the trajectory of the Anthropocene? [U] / [CO1] – Textile industry: flying shuttle, water frame, spinning jenny and mule – steam engine – coal consuming – Development in iron industry: development in furnace technology - puddling and rolling process – steel production – Electricity: discovery of electrolysis - electric motor and dynamo – electric lamp – development in road, canal, railway and waterways – Substituted human physical labour with machines – Technological advancement and the phase of great acceleration initiated with industrial revolution contributed towards a phase of human as a geological force and agent, known as Anthropocene.
21. What are the key differences between the gadgetization of humans and the humanization of gadgets? [U] / [CO3] - The gadgetization of humans refers to humans increasingly behaving like programmable, data-producing instruments — surveilled, algorithmically controlled, and reduced to biological machines, as seen in - surveillance capitalism and corporate data harvesting. The humanization of gadgets refers to technology acquiring human-like qualities — consciousness, emotion, and decision-making — as illustrated by artificial intelligence and the operating system in "Her" that develops its own consciousness.
22. Discuss the development of post-humanism in the artistic and cultural sphere [U] / [CO3] - Discuss the development of post-humanism in the artistic and cultural sphere - Richard Brautigan's poem "All Watched over by the Machines of Loving Grace" (1976) envisaged a utopian world where mammals and machines coexist in equity and harmony - Donald Fagen's I.G.Y song (1982) similarly presented a pious and just machine imagination – The movie Blade Runner (1982) manifested a new perspective about the machine life world, capturing postmodern anxieties about human life - Stelarc emerged as the guru of cyborg art over thirty years, developing various robots and performances with his technical team, with his most famous work being an ear implanted into his left arm, grown from stem cells and capable of being connected to the internet - The movie "Her," directed by Spike Jonze, further explored cyborgian ethics free from the bonds of public morality, depicting an operating system that progressively develops its own consciousness, which can be analyzed through

Raymond Williams' theoretical framework of residual, dominant, and emergent cultural forms.

Part C

Essay Questions Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 10 marks

23. Trace the implications of agricultural revolution on the social life of early humans [U] / [CO1] - The agricultural revolution forced humans to abandon their million-year-old foraging lifestyle and settle permanently near fields - leading to the emergence of permanent farming villages like Jericho by 8,500 BCE - The shift to cereal-based diets proved nutritionally damaging, as such diets were poor in minerals and vitamins, hard to digest, bad for teeth, and created dangerous dependence on single staples vulnerable to bad weather or insect attacks - Dependence on land made early agricultural communities targets of conquest and violent attacks, with fifteen percent of total deaths and twenty-five percent of male deaths in agricultural societies caused by violence - Women began giving birth every year, causing exponential population growth, though child mortality rose alarmingly to one in every three births, reflecting the harsher living conditions of settled life - The need to protect surplus food production compelled early humans to build walls, guard cereal stores and fields, and invent new tools like hoes, plows, and stone grinding instruments, fundamentally transforming their material culture - Humans also began domesticating animals through selective breeding, castration, and careful species selection, progressively making animals fatter and more submissive while using them for food, raw materials, and muscle power, fundamentally reshaping human relationships with the natural world.
24. Assess the ecological destruction with the beginning of metal smelting in the ancient world [An] / [CO2] – Environmental impact behind the decline of Harappan civilization - Late Holocene rainforest crisis in Africa with the Bantu tribesmen clearance of forest – Role of Iron and expansion of agriculture in clearance of thick forest in China - massive deforestation, causing soil erosion and yellow soil deposits in river beds, transforming the He River into the flood-prone Huang He – Significant forest cover reduction in Europe with iron tool usage – Metallurgy especially iron manufacturing consumed huge amount of wood – Huge army’s weapon needs had great ecological impacts, especially on trees – about 7 million trees would consumed for Mauryan army’s metal needs – Sculptures and coinage too required large amount of trees for furnace needs
25. Discuss the concept of value in relation with capitalist commodity production [U] / [CO5] - A commodity has two kind of values: use-value and exchange value – Every commodity is a product of human labour - The magnitude of the value in a commodity is determined by the amount of labour-time socially necessary for producing it - The capitalist mode operates on the formula Money-Commodity-Money (M-C-M), where money is invested not for production's sake but to enhance capital. Capitalists possess the means of production and exploit wage labour to extract surplus value, which is the difference between the value labour creates and what labour actually receives. This

unpaid surplus labour constitutes the profit of the capitalist, revealing the exploitative economic relations between capitalists and workers. Consequently, capitalist commodity production enables capitalists to accumulate great wealth while the working class grows progressively poorer, as even labour power itself is reduced to the status of a commodity.

26. Discuss various theoretical approach towards the study of violence [U] / [CO4] – **Historical Sociology:** Weber and Elias linked declining violence to state intervention, but twentieth-century state-sponsored atrocities and regional variations undermined this thesis - **Psychology:** Freud attributed violence to repressed biological aggression, Foucault critiqued modernity as inherently violent, and crowd theorists identified irrational destructive tendencies in collective behaviour - **Anthropology:** Gluckman and Davis challenged Eurocentric civilizing narratives, redefining violence as culturally embedded and emphasizing negotiated justice over state coercion - **Evolutionary Psychology:** Pinker linked declining violence to biological self-control, but critics argued violence derives from social relations and honour codes rather than biological determinism - **Interdisciplinary Studies:** The most comprehensive approach integrates social relations, state-civil society dynamics, emotional factors, environmental destabilizers, and political enmity, rejecting linear deterministic frameworks.